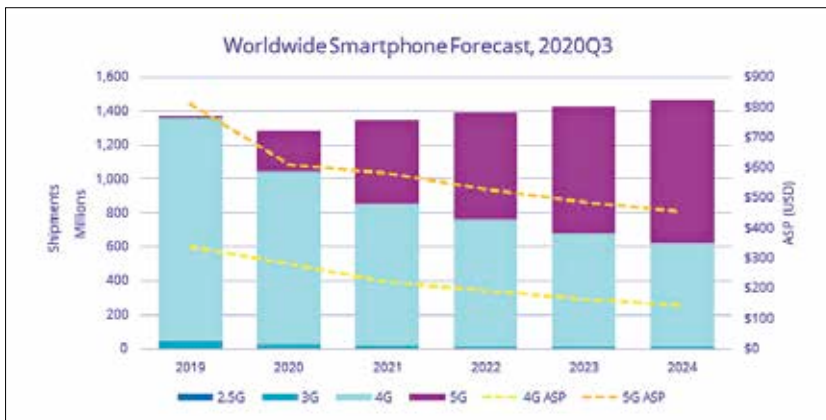


that are making people's lives more convenient and comfortable, and these experiences are being brought to life on the DOCOMO 5G network through our exciting portfolio of 5G devices powered by Qualcomm Snapdragon 5G mobile platforms. We look forward to the next generation

is working round the clock towards strengthening India's technology base. With this lab setup, while we work towards developing core technologies for 5G era and strengthen the overall ecosystem, we also aim to support India in its 5G journey. The technologies developed at the



Source: IDC

IDC forecast for 5G adoption in smartphones

of 5G devices powered by Qualcomm Technologies' industry-leading Snapdragon 888 5G Mobile Platform to deliver the best experiences on DOCOMO's 5G network."

Some experts anticipate a rather unexpected form factor to make a comeback because of 5G.

Edward Lin, Deputy Director at MIC, a Taiwanese industry tracker says "While the 5G smartphone market is expected to keep expanding, smartphone brands will be able to offer enough variety in product range and specifications. The foldable design is expected to be a new area of focus for 5G smartphones. With 5G helping power 8K video streaming, 5G foldable smartphones guarantee better viewing experience with an extended screen. Although foldable smartphones are slated for commercialisation, yield rates and prices are still problems."

In December 2020, Oppo set up a 5G research centre in Hyderabad, that is focused on developing 5G technologies not only for India, but to the rest of the world as well. The initiative is expected to accelerate 5G roll out in the country. Mr Tasleem Arif, Vice President & Head, R&D OPPO India said "5G development is a key focus area for OPPO and our R&D facility

lab will mark a global footprint while promising our vision to make India an innovation hub."

03 NFT MARKETPLACES

Non fungible tokens are still the hottest things in distributed ledger technologies. Considering that the scale of adoption of blockchain based technologies is still extremely limited compared to the potential use cases, there is tremendous activity in the space with a lot of players moving in to capitalise on the trend of non fungible tokens. Essentially, a non fungible token is unique and cannot be broken up into smaller components. Think of it as a hundred rupee note with a special serial number that has your birthdate on it, there is nothing else in the world exactly like it, and the value of that note is not equal to another ten rupee note, or for coins or other notes that total up to a value of 100 rupees. The concept of non fungibility has been successfully used to create a market of digital collectibles, such as CryptoCarz, CryptoKitties and Cryptocities. There is a requirement for shared ecosystems of digital collectibles, and exchanges for decen-

tralised finances markets to trade in digital assets. NFTs have also been used to drive conservation attempts in China, through CryptoPanda. We can expect to see more real world applications and integrations going forward. One of the reasons why tokens fail is their liquidity is not assured, and we can expect to see a number of interesting ways to address this issue. In December 2020, project NUC was announced under the trusteeship of the Gemological Institute of America. The divisible, non-fungible, transferable and decentralised tokens are meant to be used for estate planning and avoiding facing costly legal fees. The tokens are tradeable on the blockchain and are based on the market value of an uncut ruby appraised at \$783,000,000.00 USD. The NUC founders said, "We would like to dedicate this massive project to improving the quality of life of all people seeking to secure their wealth".

GoldenPyrex is an effort to improve liquidity of tokens by reducing the friction in transactions, by removing as many intermediaries as possible. It is essentially a complete ecosystem, with a market, that supports integrations with multiple collectibles. As an increasing number of items are added to the marketplace, the liquidity of the tokens increases. The ecosystem was rolled out on December 2020. Ilyas Sadvasakov, the founder of GPYX says, "GoldenPyrex is making it easier and realisable for DeFi enthusiasts to merge multiutility with the ability to earn in a secured manner. With rewards already set for our loyal followers to earn from farming yield on supported pools, we are confident we are unlocking a new evolution in the convergence between the several components of modern DeFi such as Yield Farming, NFTs, and the ability for the GPYX token holders to also explore the world of Games within the Gamehouse platform." In December last year, we had another NFT trading platform launch the XENO NFT Hub with auctions, trade tracking, user ratings and other regular features of digital marketplaces. Anthony Di Franco, the president of